



PHOTO BY **CHANDRADEEP KUMAR**

No industry is more emblematic of the frenetic pace of activity there than hospitality. Here, for instance, Indian Hotels Company Ltd (IHCL)—which owns popular brands like Taj Hotels and Vivanta—is coming up with two properties. According to Suma Venkatesh, Executive Vice President—Real Estate & Development at IHCL, the company took the leap of faith because Ayodhya, the revered birthplace of Lord Ram, is expected to attract significant footfall from pilgrims throughout the year. “IHCL has underscored its commitment by signing manage-

ment contracts for two new properties in Ayodhya—a 100-room Vivanta hotel and a 120-room Ginger hotel, both expected to be operational in 36 months,” she tells *BT*.

Diversified conglomerate ITC Ltd—a leading player in the luxury- and mid-segment hotels business—is in discussions with developers to offer branding and management solutions for their assets under de-

tors exploring the city’s iconic attractions,” says Anuj Tejpal, Chief Merchant Officer at OYO.

According to Jaideep Dang, Head of hotels & hospitality, India at real estate services firm JLL, some four to five luxury hotel chains have already lined up properties aggregating to capacity of 1,100 rooms. The enthusiasm isn’t unfounded. Per estimates, some 300,000 tourists are expected

FRENETIC PACE

- 1 Private enterprises and government officials are congregating at Ayodhya ahead of its inauguration by PM Narendra Modi on January 22
- 2 The central and state governments have announced investments of ₹85,000 crore to upgrade the infrastructure in the town
- 3 Anticipating a surge in demand, luxury hotel chains have lined up properties, with a total capacity of around 1,100 rooms
- 4 Indian Railways plans to launch 15 trains to connect Ayodhya with key cities. The PM recently flagged off the first Amrit Bharat train

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velopment. “It is encouraging to see rapid growth in overall infrastructure as a catalyst for the expected tourism surge. Any market with such large-scale expected movement of travellers, would need quality accommodation across segments,” says Anil Chadha, Divisional Chief Executive at ITC Hotels.

OYO, the country’s largest hotel chain operator, plans to add 50 hotels and homes, aggregating to some 1,000 rooms. “These new properties will be strategically located near Ayodhya’s prominent landmarks, ensuring convenient access for visi-

to visit the holy town every day.

Apart from hotels, there are the massive infrastructure development projects announced by the central and state governments. Under the Ayodhya Master Plan 2031, projects worth ₹85,000 crore will be executed to upgrade the town’s infrastructure. The government has already unveiled a new international airport and a revamped railway junction as well. During a recent visit to the town, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said, “Infrastructure-related works will once again establish modern Ayodhya with pride on the